INDUSTRY STARTER PACKS FOR ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTS

Insurance

The complete set — what is in it, what each piece is for, and the order to pick them up

Two volumes, six spreadsheets, three decks and the worked example they were all built against. Read this first: it says which file answers which question, and which three you need in your first week.

South African lens. Sourced throughout. October 2026.

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Thotnr Consulting

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GUIDE 1

What is in this set

Sixteen files. Three of them matter in your first week.

This set exists so that an architect who has never worked in insurance can walk into an insurer and be useful. Not eventually — within a quarter.

It comes in four parts and a worked example. The two books teach and instruct, the spreadsheets are what you actually fill in, the decks are what you put on a screen in front of other people, and the Meridian files are a complete, populated example of what the finished thing looks like.

Read these three first

> **IF YOU READ NOTHING ELSE**
>
> `01 Learner guide` — read it once, front to back, before you start. It is the industry.
>
> `02 Workbook` — never read front to back. Open it at the phase you are in and work the numbered steps.
>
> `03 Excel templates / Insurance_EA_Metamodel_TEMPLATE.xlsx` — the empty repository. Everything the workbook tells you to do lands in it.

The whole set

Folder	File	What it is	When you use it
01	Insurance — a starter pack for enterprise architects	The learner guide. 237 pages, 22 chapters, 160 figures.	Read once, keep beside you
02	Insurance — the architecture workbook	The ADM workbook. 282 pages, 157 numbered steps, 36 printable forms.	Every working day
03	Insurance_EA_Metamodel_TEMPLATE.xlsx	The empty repository. 164 sheets, 293 dropdowns.	From day one
03	Insurance_EA_Comparison_Tool_TEMPLATE.xlsx	Baseline against target, with the governed-drift test.	Phase E, then quarterly
03	Insurance_EA_Workshop_Capture.xlsx	Live capture for four of the five workshops.	In the room
03	Insurance_EA_Transcription_Forms.xlsx	57 sheets matching the printed forms.	Typing up paper
03	Insurance_EA_Principles_and_Standards.xlsx	45 principles, 31 standards, ready to adopt or argue with.	Preliminary phase
03	Insurance_EA_Maturity_Assessment.xlsx	21 scored dimensions with the evidence for each.	First month, then annually
04	Insurance_EA_Executive_Briefing.pptx	23 slides for the executive committee.	End of the first quarter
04	Insurance_EA_View_Templates.pptx	52 slides: all 44 ArchiMate 4 views, empty and guided.	Whenever you draw
04	Insurance_EA_Workshop_Pack.pptx	48 slides facilitating the five workshops.	In the room
05	Meridian_TOGAF_Metamodel.xlsx	The worked example — a fully populated repository.	When you want to see what finished looks like
05	Meridian_Architecture_Comparison_Tool.xlsx	The same, for the diff tool.	Alongside the template
05	Meridian_ArchiMate4_Views.pptx	Worked ArchiMate 4 views of that repository.	Alongside the view templates
05	Meridian_Metamodel_How_To_Use.pptx	How the repository works.	Before you load anything
05	Meridian_Comparison_Tool_How_To_Use.pptx	How the diff tool works.	Before Phase E

The two books, and why they are separate

	Volume 1 — the learner guide	Volume 2 — the workbook
Read	once, front to back	never front to back
Answers	what this industry is and how it runs	what do I do on Monday
Shelf life	keep it as reference	consumed — you write in it
Pages	237	282

Volume 1 covers the lines of business, the vocabulary, the business model, the roles, the money, the operating model, the process model in BPMN, the data model, the application landscape, the reference architecture, the providers, the regulator, and how to model all of it in ArchiMate 4. Volume 2 takes the ADM phase by phase and says which sheet, which columns, who signs it, how you know it is done, and how it usually goes wrong.

They interlock. Every step in volume 2 that has teaching behind it carries a **Look it up** line naming the volume 1 chapter and section, and volume 2's appendix E indexes all 157 steps back to volume 1.

Print volume 2

Volume 2 is built to be printed and written in. It carries 36 printable forms whose columns are the real columns of the real sheets, 65 question sets with ruled answer space, and working tables inside the steps. Print the forms for the phase you are in, fill them by hand in the room, and transcribe the same day.

> THE TRANSCRIPTION LOOP
>
> Paper in the room, spreadsheet the same afternoon, repository record with a change reference. Paper that is never typed up is a wasted workshop; a record typed up without a change reference is a repository that will rot inside a year.

The notation

Everything that is architecture is modelled in **ArchiMate 4** — 42 elements, 11 relationships. The one exception is level-2 process models, drawn in BPMN 2.0, because ArchiMate has no swimlanes and no hand-offs, and in a process model the hand-off is the point. Volume 1 chapter 16 teaches the notation; volume 2 appendix D maps all 66 object sheets and all 56 relationship sheets of the repository onto it.

Two invented insurers, kept apart

Cape Mutual is volume 1's running example — a South African composite used to make the teaching concrete. **Meridian Assurance Group** is the insurer in the worked-example repository. Both are

inventions. Every figure attributed to either is illustrative, and every file that carries their numbers says so.

What this set does not do

It does not pick your vendor. The providers chapter names who plays in each category and says plainly, at both ends, that these are examples and not recommendations. It does not replace legal or actuarial advice — the regulatory chapters tell you what the regulator inspects and which columns are the evidence, not whether your particular arrangement complies. And it does not fill itself in: the repository template ships empty on purpose, because an architecture repository somebody else populated is a document, not an architecture.